

well when he lived at home. It was a sparse but workable budget, and they made it.

It's sad to see how many young couples don't make it because they get married with no financial training at all. If you think the schools will do this training for you, think again. For years I tried to get Christian schools to establish a basic home finance class and make it mandatory for graduation. Even after writing the curriculum for it, I found virtually no takers.

Since it wasn't a part of the "approved" curriculum by the accreditation groups, they couldn't spare the time. I wondered what ever happened to God's accreditation system. I have since taken the material into homes and churches where it has been enthusiastically adopted. I'll share a few of the ideas in the next chapter.

Don't expect your children to jump up and down with joy when you begin to enforce financial discipline, including a budget. I remember when my strong-willed son (hardheaded) was about 12 years old and I started him on a budget. He had been used to spending his money, which he earned, pretty much the way he desired. I knew a budget was in his best interest, but he didn't see it that way at all.

We were about three weeks into the budgeting process, which included about half of his money going into savings, when he came into my office one day and said, "Dad, this is not a very democratic way to run a family." I said, "You're right, Son, and don't forget you don't live in a democracy in our home: you live in a benevolent dictatorship."

He mumbled and grumbled from time to time because he couldn't stand to think about unspent money. But he survived and we did too.

Later he joined the Marine reserves, where he went through boot camp training and then through a year of electronics training. I was speaking in California, where he was stationed, and I decided to drive out to see him one Sunday afternoon.

You need to realize that the whole time my son was living at home, he was always arguing, "Dad, this isn't right, that isn't